

United States History and Geography — Student Form

United States History and Geography · Tennessee Academic Standards 2027-28 · Form US-CORE-C

classroom-formative · pre-field-test. Item parameters are estimates and have not met a student; this form is not a calibrated instrument. This is a selected-response form. It assesses Depth of Knowledge levels 1 through 3. It carries no extended-response item, so it does not assess DOK-4 — a four-option question cannot ask a student to construct and defend an argument. Extended responses and document-based questions are delivered as separate activities.

1. What was President Roosevelt's primary motivation for attempting to add justices to the Supreme Court in 1937?

- A.** To fulfill a campaign promise he had made to expand the Court to include more diverse justices
- B.** To reduce the workload on existing justices who were overwhelmed by the volume of Depression-era cases
- C.** To add justices who would be more likely to uphold New Deal programs that the Court had been striking down
- D.** To ensure that justices who had served beyond the constitutional age limit would be replaced

2. Critics of the New Deal charged that Roosevelt's programs represented a dangerous move toward socialism. Defenders argued the New Deal actually saved capitalism. Which reasoning provides the strongest defense of the argument that the New Deal **PRESERVED** rather than threatened the capitalist system?

- A.** The New Deal preserved capitalism because it was funded entirely through taxation and borrowing rather than government ownership of businesses, ensuring that private enterprise remained the foundation of the American economy.
- B.** The New Deal preserved capitalism because FDR's willingness to accept deficit spending demonstrated that a capitalist democracy could respond to crises more flexibly than socialist command economies.
- C.** The New Deal preserved capitalism because Roosevelt explicitly rejected socialist proposals such as nationalizing the banking system, choosing instead to restore private banks to profitability through the FDIC.
- D.** The New Deal preserved capitalism by using government power to restore the conditions market economies require — consumer purchasing power, banking stability, and honest financial markets — preventing the complete collapse that was fueling calls for genuinely radical alternatives.

3. How did the Truman Doctrine and the Marshall Plan work together to advance the U.S. policy of containment in Europe after World War II?

- A.** The Truman Doctrine offered military and political support to countries resisting communist takeover, while the Marshall Plan provided economic aid to rebuild war-devastated nations
- B.** The Truman Doctrine provided military aid to rebuild European industries, while the Marshall Plan trained European armies
- C.** The Truman Doctrine and Marshall Plan replaced the United Nations as the primary international peacekeeping organization
- D.** Both programs were designed solely to counter the Soviet Union in Asia rather than in Europe

4. Which conclusion about the Marshall Plan is best supported by the fact that it offered economic reconstruction aid to all European nations, including those within the Soviet sphere of influence?

- A.** The offer to Soviet-aligned nations demonstrated that the United States did not yet view the Soviet Union as a long-term strategic adversary.
- B.** American policymakers believed that economic recovery would reduce the appeal of communist political movements in war-devastated European nations.
- C.** The Marshall Plan was designed primarily as a humanitarian relief program to prevent civilian starvation in postwar Europe.
- D.** American policymakers genuinely expected the Soviet Union to participate in the Marshall Plan and integrate its economy into Western trade networks.

5. What happened to Prince Edward County, Virginia schools after Brown v. Board?

- A.** They immediately integrated without any resistance from local officials
- B.** They successfully maintained segregation through legal loopholes
- C.** They closed public schools for five years rather than integrate
- D.** They became a model for peaceful integration in the South

6. Why did many Southern states resist implementing the Brown v. Board of Education ruling even years after the 1954 decision?

- A.** The Supreme Court's ruling lacked enforcement authority, so states could legally ignore federal court orders without consequence
- B.** Congress had passed legislation blocking the enforcement of the ruling in states that had voted against integration
- C.** The ruling only applied to schools in states where segregation had been challenged in court, leaving most Southern schools unaffected
- D.** The Court's instruction to desegregate 'with all deliberate speed' allowed states to delay implementation, and local officials used political and social pressure to resist change

7. What organization did Martin Luther King Jr. help found after the Montgomery Bus Boycott?
- A. The Southern Christian Leadership Conference to coordinate civil rights efforts
 - B. Using peaceful protests to create tension that forces negotiation and change
 - C. He became the first African American student at the University of Mississippi
 - D. He was a Birmingham civil rights leader who helped organize the 1963 campaign
8. How did Orval Faubus's actions during the Little Rock Crisis of 1957 reflect the broader pattern of Southern resistance to civil rights?
- A. Faubus refused to enforce segregation laws after the Supreme Court's ruling, making Little Rock a model of voluntary compliance
 - B. Faubus used the Arkansas National Guard to block Black students from entering Central High School, directly defying federal authority and forcing President Eisenhower to respond with federal troops
 - C. Faubus supported the federal government's desegregation orders and called on the National Guard to protect Black students entering Central High School
 - D. Faubus appealed to Congress to pass legislation overturning the Brown decision, making Little Rock a political rather than a military confrontation
9. How did the Civil Rights Act of 1964 build upon and go beyond earlier civil rights legislation?
- A. The 1964 Act required immediate desegregation of all schools within one year, accelerating the timeline set by Brown v. Board
 - B. The 1964 Act was the first federal law to address racial discrimination since Reconstruction, as Congress had not passed any civil rights legislation in the twentieth century before 1964
 - C. The 1964 Act prohibited discrimination in public accommodations, employment, and federally assisted programs, addressing areas of daily life that earlier, weaker civil rights acts had not protected
 - D. The 1964 Act focused exclusively on voting rights, extending protections that earlier acts had established for school integration
10. African American voter registration in the southern states covered by the Voting Rights Act of 1965 rose from approximately 29% in 1965 to over 60% by 1969. Which conclusion is best supported by this trend?
- A. African American voter registration declined sharply between 1965 and 1968
 - B. Mississippi had the highest African American voter registration rate in 1965
 - C. Voter registration rates remained constant in the South during this period
 - D. African American voter registration in the South increased dramatically after the Voting Rights Act